

In Adobe Experience Manager (AEM), **Content Fragments (CFs) are pure, structured content without layout**, delivered as clean JSON for consumption by any channel, while **Experience Fragments (XFs) are fully laid-out content sections that combine content and design**, delivered as JSON with embedded HTML/component data for consistent visual experiences .

Content Fragments vs. Experience Fragments in Headless Delivery

Feature	Content Fragments (CF)	Experience Fragments (XF)
Focus	Content flexibility and reuse ("what" the content is).	Presentation and consistent layout ("how" it looks).
Structure	Structured data based on a Content Fragment Model (schema).	A group of AEM components (text, image, etc.) with a predefined layout.
Management	Stored as Assets in the DAM, managed via the Content Fragments console .	Stored as AEM pages, managed via the Experience Fragments console .
Headless Delivery	Delivered as clean JSON via the AEM GraphQL API or the Assets REST API.	Delivered as JSON with embedded HTML/component data via AEM Content Services/API pages or exported to Adobe Target .
Use Case	Author bios, product descriptions, FAQs, or news articles where the display varies by channel.	Hero banners, promotions, footers, or navigation bars that must maintain a consistent look across different sites or channels.

JSON Examples (Conceptual)

The actual JSON output structure depends on your specific AEM Core Components and Content Fragment Models.

Content Fragment JSON Example

The Content Fragment JSON is clean and structured, mirroring the defined model fields. A client application receives this raw data and applies its own styling and layout.

json

```
{
  "data": {
    "authorByPath": {
```

```

    "item": {
      "firstName": "Michael",
      "lastName": "Grob",
      "email": "michael.grob@example.com",
      "shortBio": "An AEM expert and author...",
      "headshot": {
        "_path": "/content/dam/asset.jpg"
      }
    }
  }
}

```

Consumed via AEM GraphQL API. [🔗](#)

Experience Fragment JSON Example

The Experience Fragment JSON is more complex. It typically contains a structure of components, including their properties and the resulting HTML markup, which the consuming application might render directly or use to instantiate pre-built UI components. [🔗](#)

json



```

{
  ":type": "mysite/components/xfpage",
  "dataLayer": {...},
  ":items": {
    "root": {
      ":type": "mysite/components/container",
      "layout": "responsive grid",
      ":items": {
        "image": {
          ":type": "mysite/components/image",
          "src": "/content/dam/campaigns/hero-banner.jpg",
          "alt": "Campaign hero banner",
          "width": "100%",
          "lazy": true
        },
        "text": {
          ":type": "mysite/components/text",
          "text": "<p>Check out our new products!</p>",
          "richText": true
        },
        "button": {
          ":type": "mysite/components/button",

```

```
        "text": "Shop Now",  
        "link": "/content/mysite/shop"  
    }  
}  
},  
":itemsOrder": ["image", "text", "button"]  
}
```

Consumed via AEM Content Services/API Pages.